

Know Thy Enemy (Part 4) : Baal

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In the previous part of this series, I demonstrated that the old gods are still around and active in today's age - as they have been throughout history [1]. One of the most known and most mentioned of the old gods is Baal. Throughout scripture, Baal appears as the head deity of the Canaanites and Phoenicians and tied to agriculture, fertility, child sacrifice¹, and political power²[2]. Baal is referenced about 80 times in the old testament alone. The context is almost always that of spiritual adultery and apostasy³[2]. This framing of Baal is from ancient times; therefore, what is Baal's role in the modern age?

The Hebrew word *Baal* literally means 'lord' [4], 'master'[2], or 'owner'[2].

References

- [1] Torode, Antonius, *Know Thy Enemy (part 3): The Old Gods*, June 2026. <https://github.com/torodean/bible-notes/blob/main/sermonettes/Know%20Thy%20Enemy/The%20Old%20Gods/The%20Old%20Gods.pdf>
- [2] Bible Hub: Baal. Accessed 27 June 2026. <https://biblehub.com/hebrew/1167.htm>, <https://biblehub.com/hebrew/1168.htm>
- [3] "Apostasy." Merriam-Webster.com Dictionary, Merriam-Webster, <https://www.merriam-webster.com/dictionary/apostasy>. Accessed 27 June 2026.
- [4] "KJV W/ STRONGS BIBLE." <https://godrules.net/library/kjvstrongs/kjvstrongs.htm>

¹Jeremiah 19:5 - "And have built the high places of Baal to burn their sons in the fire as burnt offerings to Baal."

²There is a constant theme in the scriptures of entire nations bending to and worshiping Baal. An example being Judges 2:11-13 - "Then the children of Israel did evil in the sight of the Lord, and served the Baals" ... "They forsook the Lord and served Baal and the Ashtoreths."

³"An act of refusing to continue to follow, obey, or recognize a religious faith" [3]